



Mate-eater

The female black widow spider often eats the male spider after he has mated with her. She contains poison that is 15 times more deadly than the poison of a rattlesnake.

Talking birds

Pet parrots can be taught to speak. They can also learn how to recognize colors, shapes, and numbers.



Fearsome fish

South American piranhas have a reputation for killing cows, horses, and people. While they do have sharp teeth and a strong bite, they can only tackle large prey if it is dead or dying.



Living mouthful

The frontosa cichlid protects her young by holding them in her mouth while they are small. She spits out the young fish so that they can feed.



Longest journey

Every year, the Arctic tern migrates from the Arctic to the Antarctic and back, a return trip of 16,000 miles (26,000 km).



Long life

The New Zealand tuatara often lives for 120 years or more and its eggs may take up to 15 months to hatch.



Smelly spray

The North American skunk sprays a nasty-smelling liquid over its enemies and can hit a target accurately from about 12 ft (3.6 m) away.

Short life

The adult mayfly lives for only a few days. It spends its short life looking for a mate. Its young may live for a year or more.



Noisiest animal

The howler monkeys of the tropical American rainforests are the noisiest land animals. Their calls can be heard up to 2 miles (3 km) away.



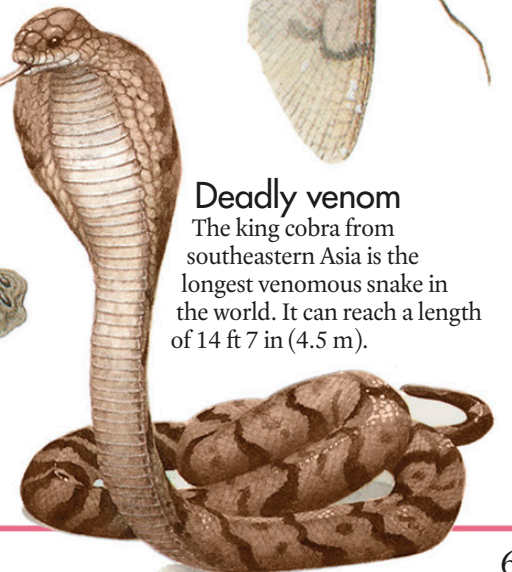
Egg-laying mammal

The Australian platypus is a very unusual mammal because it lays eggs. When the young hatch out, they feed on their mother's milk, which they suck off the fur on her stomach.



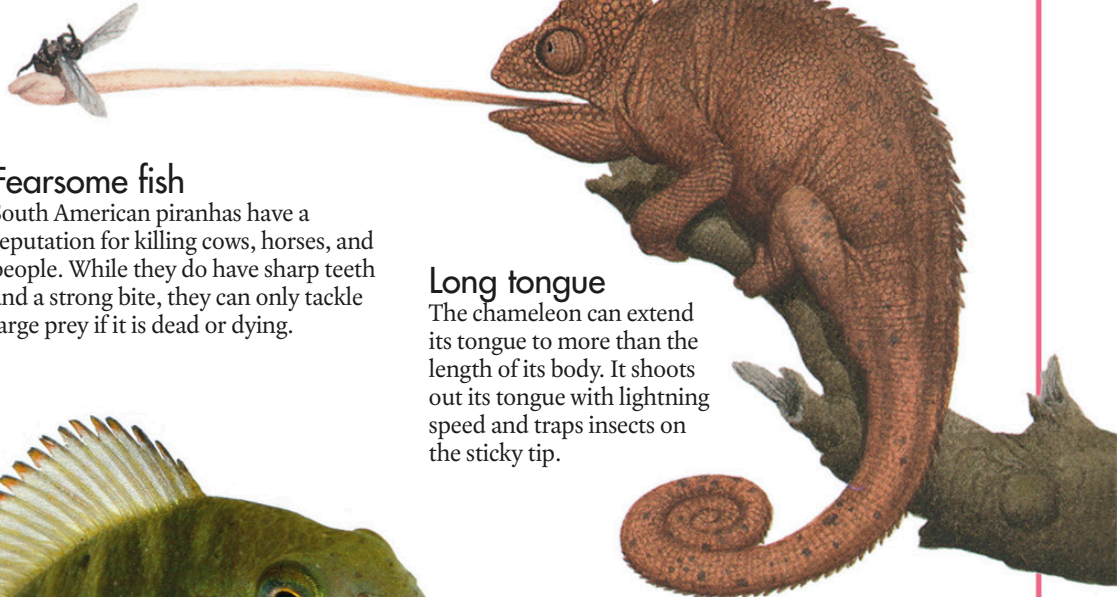
Deadly venom

The king cobra from southeastern Asia is the longest venomous snake in the world. It can reach a length of 14 ft 7 in (4.5 m).



Long tongue

The chameleon can extend its tongue to more than the length of its body. It shoots out its tongue with lightning speed and traps insects on the sticky tip.



Big mouth

The African egg-eating snake can swallow eggs twice the size of its own head. Its jaws are hinged with special ligaments that stretch open to allow the egg to pass down its throat.